with Turkey.

Not until World War II, when she decisively threw back the German offensive towards the Caucasus, did Russia reassume her full position as a Great Power in the Middle East. Today her prestige in the region is perhaps greater than that of any other world power. Her influence is particularly strong on her own neighbors, Turkey and Iran, but it is also potentially strong elsewhere. The sources of her prestige are two; first, her imposing military accomplishments, and second, her successes in dealing with the problems of development of backward peoples within her own frontiers. On the other hand, there are basic limitations on immediate Soviet strength in the Middle East in the current political impotence of the masses and the intense fear of Communism among the governing classes.

France and Britain were the principal heirs of the Ottoman Empire in the Middle East -- the lion's share going to Britain. France claims equality of status in the region with any other world power because of her "historical connection" reaching back to the Crusades. French is the cultural language of the region, and its young nationalisms have fed on French (and American) models. But her political and economic position in the Middle East has never been basically strong during the last quarter century. France has never been sufficiently interested in the Middle East to pursue an active development policy there. Moreover, from the days of the episodes candidly recited by T. E. Lawrence to the present, one element of British policy has embraced the elimination of French influence from the Middle East. French political influence has, in fact, been almost entirely eliminated in World War II. It may be, however, that amicable Anglo-French relations in Europe and other areas will require that France be given back a shred of "special position".

At present, Great Britain is the strongest world power in the Middle East. She holds mandates over Palestine and Transjordan, has special treaties with Egypt and Iraq, exercises military occupation in parts of Iran, Syria and Lebanon, and has an alliance with Turkey. Moreover, she has important investment interests throughout the area; she is its huge debtor on blocked sterling account;and